Riverside Library Network: Annual Review 2025

Summary

The Riverside Library Network operates five branches across the eastern districts. In 2025 the network extended its opening hours on weekday evenings. Membership grew steadily throughout the year, with the strongest gains among students.

The network also completed the move of its archive to a climate-controlled store. Staff turnover remained low, and two new librarians joined in the spring.

Visitor Numbers

Total visits reached a new high in the autumn months. The Canal Street branch recorded the largest increase after its refurbishment. Online loans continued to rise, although printed books still account for most borrowing.

Programmes

Weekly homework clubs ran in every branch during term time. The digital skills course for older readers was fully booked within days. A new series of author evenings attracted audiences from outside the district.

Outlook

The board plans to open a sixth branch in the harbour quarter in 2027. Funding for the project has been requested from the regional cultural fund. Until then, the mobile library will serve the harbour quarter twice a week.